

Data Analytics – Stage 3B

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Title: SEO and Keyword Analytics in Nigerian Consumer Banking

Introduction

This analysis looks into the performance of Nigerian banks in terms of visibility and keyword domination using SEO-related metrics. This study will evaluate top performing keywords, search volume, and keyword difficulty to identify the leading banks in online visibility and possibly correlate the strength of their SEO with business performance.

Data Collection

Sources:

- Google Ads Keyword Planner
- Mangools Keyword Finder

Data Collected:

- Bank-related keywords and actual keywords
- Average search volume (past 12 months)
- Cost per Click (CPC) and Price per Click (PPC)
- Estimated search value
- Keyword difficulty score
- Keyword interest growth rate (%)

Process:

1. Selected the top 15 Nigerian banks based on brand relevance and market share.
2. Grouped the keywords into 8 categories under the Actual Keyword column (e.g., *Loans & Credit, Online Banking, Account Opening, Bank Codes*, etc.).

3. Collected SEO metrics from Google and Mangools for each bank keyword.
4. Cleaned and standardized the dataset in Excel to eliminate inconsistencies and duplicates.
5. Imported the data into Power BI for transformation and visualization.
6. Built an interactive dashboard visualizing the following:
 - Bank ranks by Average search volume.
 - Average difficulty by bank
 - Bank by Interest growth
 - Keyword by Average paid Competition
 - Keyword by Average difficulty
 - Summary table
 - Bank visibility share (%)

Key Insights

1. **Bank Visibility and Keyword Dominance:** The analysis of total average search volume shows a clear hierarchy in online visibility and brand search demand. The following insights were seen:
 - Zenith Bank has the most online visibility, dominating with 33.1% of the total search volume across the selected banks.
 - First Bank and Access Bank hold the 2nd and 3rd ranks, respectively, combining for nearly a quarter of the total search volume.
 - The top three banks collectively account for approximately 57.8% of the total search volume, indicating a high concentration of online visibility among a few key banks.
2. **Average Difficulty by Bank:** The average keyword difficulty score suggests the competitive effort required to rank for a bank's keywords:
 - UBA has the highest average keyword difficulty at 20.2.
 - Most banks fall between a range of 4.2 - 11.2, with the lowest being Heritage Bank at 4.2.
3. **Bank by Interest Growth:** The interest growth of the banks was also analysed and these are the following insights;
 - Keystone Bank shows the most significant positive momentum with an average interest growth of 102.3% across its keywords, suggesting a sharp recent increase in search popularity.
 - Other banks with strong positive growth include Stabic ibtc Bank (55.7%), Wema Bank (39.2%), and Fidelity (36.3%). This could indicate successful brand awareness campaigns or new product interest.

- In contrast, Heritage Bank (-39.4%) and GTB (-31.7%) show the largest decline in average keyword interest growth, which may warrant further investigation into changing consumer behaviour or competitive pressures.

4. Keyword Group Analysis (Keyword by Average paid Competition and Average Difficulty): Keywords can be grouped to understand high-value areas within the industry:

- **Monetization Focus:** The highest paid competition (PPC) is for Account Opening & Signup at 9.4, followed by Loans & Credit at 5.2. This signifies that banks are investing heavily in paid ads for these categories, which are directly tied to customer acquisition and lending revenue.
- **High-Value Difficulty:** Keywords related to Internet/Online Banking (8.4), Bank Brand Keywords (7.9), and Mobile & App Banking (7.7) have higher average difficulty scores, making organic ranking for these terms more challenging.
- **Low Difficulty:** Corporate/Business Banking and Promotions/Campaigns/Specific Products have an average difficulty of 0.0, indicating they are either highly specialized, low-competition terms, or newly tracked keywords.

Conclusion

Zenith Bank dominates the Nigerian banking SEO landscape by a wide margin in terms of total search volume and brand visibility. Although the top three players- Zenith, First, and Access-dominate the market, there is strong positive growth in search interest from mid-tier players like Keystone Bank, Wema Bank, and Fidelity. The most competitive and monetized keyword categories are those most closely related to core business functions, including Account Opening & Signup and Loans & Credit. Banks will want to use these insights as an indication that either significant resources should be used to compete for high-value keywords or resources are more effectively spent on lower-difficulty, high-growth terms to capture emerging search demand.